



First run with your API key

A step-by-step checklist for the day you add your key: what to run, what you should see, which permissions to allow, and what to try first.

Jarvis 1.0, October 2026

In this document

- Before you start
- The checklist: nine steps, about 20 minutes
- Permissions at a glance
- First things to try
- Keeping costs in check
- If something looks wrong

Before you start

- Jarvis is installed: `./setup.sh` finished, and `./run.sh --version` prints `Jarvis 1.0.0 (phase 10 of 10)`.
- You have an API key from platform.claude.com (Settings, then API keys) and credit on the account.
- You've set a monthly spend limit in the Claude Console.
- Terminal is open in your Jarvis folder: `cd ~/Projects/jarvis`.

The checklist

1. Add your key

```
open -e .env
```

Paste the key after `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=` with no quotes or spaces, then save and close TextEdit.

```
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=sk-ant-api03-...
```

The key stays on your Mac: git ignores `.env`, so it never reaches GitHub.

2. Run the doctor

```
./run.sh --doctor
```

You should see ✓ on most lines, and at the end of the Claude API section: "Claude replied: Jarvis online."

On the first run these are normal: ! for Accessibility and Screen Recording (you'll allow them in steps 6 and 7), and · "Speech model ... not downloaded yet". If the Claude line fails, the doctor says why: a rejected key, no credit or an unknown model.

3. Test the microphone

```
./run.sh --listen
```

The first time, Jarvis downloads its speech model (about 480 MB) and macOS asks whether Terminal may use the microphone: click OK. Press Enter, say "testing one two three", and pause.

You should see: You said: "Testing one, two, three." Press Ctrl+C to leave.

"Pure silence" means the permission is missing: allow Terminal in System Settings, Privacy & Security, Microphone, then quit and reopen Terminal.

4. Chat in the terminal

```
./run.sh --cli
```

Type	You should see
What's the capital of Japan?	A short answer.
What's new in the latest version of Python?	"· Searching the web...", then an answer.
Remember that I'm learning Python.	"· Remembering: ..."; <code>/memory</code> then lists it.
Make a folder called hello with a Python script that prints Hello, and run it.	Status lines for writing and running; the folder appears in <code>~/JarvisWorkspace/hello</code> .
Delete the hello folder.	Jarvis asks "Allow? [y/N]". Type n: Jarvis accepts and offers another way.
<code>/usage</code> , then <code>/quit</code>	The tokens used so far, then back to the shell.

5. Talk in the terminal

```
./run.sh --cli --voice
```

Press Enter on an empty line and ask "What time is it?": you should hear the answer. Then say "Write a note for me": Jarvis asks what it should say and listens for your answer without another Enter.

6. The menu-bar app and hotkeys

```
./run.sh
```

A Jarvis icon appears in the menu bar. macOS asks to let Terminal control the computer using accessibility features: open System Settings and turn Terminal on. Within a few seconds Jarvis says the hotkeys are working.

Do this	You should see
Press <code>^⌘C</code> and say "Open GitHub in Safari."	The panel with an ice-blue orb while listening, then "Working on it", then the answer spoken; Safari opens GitHub.
Hold right <code>⌘</code> Option, say "What's two plus two?", release	The same, without pressing a key combination.
Press <code>^⌘J</code> and type "Turn on dark mode"	macOS asks to let Terminal control System Events: OK. Dark mode turns on.
Press Esc while Jarvis is speaking	The speech stops at once.

Keep the Terminal window open while Jarvis runs; closing it quits Jarvis.

7. Tutor mode

Press `^⌘T` and ask "What am I looking at?". The first time, macOS asks to let Terminal record the screen: allow it, then quit Terminal completely (`⌘Q`), reopen it, `cd ~/Projects/jarvis` and run `./run.sh` again.

Then open System Settings, press `⌘T` and ask “Where do I change the wallpaper?”. The amber pointer glides to the right place and Jarvis reads out the label.

8. Optional extras

```
./setup.sh --wakeword
```

Then add these lines to `config.local.yaml`, restart Jarvis and say “Hey Jarvis”:

```
wake_word:  
  enabled: true
```

```
./run.sh --login on
```

This starts Jarvis at login; macOS asks to let Terminal control System Events: OK.

9. Final check

```
./run.sh --doctor
```

Every line shows ✓ or . You're all set.

Permissions at a glance

All permissions go to Terminal (or iTerm, if that's what you use). Find them in System Settings, Privacy & Security.

Permission	Needed for	When macOS asks	After allowing
Microphone	Listening	First <code>--listen</code> or <code>⌘C</code>	Quit and reopen Terminal
Accessibility	Hotkeys, typing into apps, reading selected text	First <code>./run.sh</code>	Nothing: hotkeys start within seconds
Screen Recording	Tutor mode	First <code>⌘T</code>	Quit and reopen Terminal
Automation	Controlling apps such as Music, Notes or System Events	The first time for each app	Nothing
Files and Folders	Reading Desktop, Documents and Downloads	The first time Jarvis reads them	Nothing
Notifications	Messages when the panel can't show them	The first notification	Nothing

First things to try

Ask	What it shows off
"Explain recursion with a simple example, then quiz me."	Teaching
"Create a to-do list web page in a folder called todo and open it."	Writing and running code
"Read the PDF in my Downloads called assignment and list what I need to do."	Reading documents
Select some text, press <code>^⌘C</code> : "Summarise this and put it on my clipboard."	Selections and the clipboard
"Add a reminder to submit my assignment tomorrow at 9 am."	Controlling apps
<code>^⌘T</code> : "How do I commit my changes in VS Code?"	The tutor pointer
"Remember that I prefer short answers."	Long-term memory

Keeping costs in check

- The default model is `claude-sonnet-5-5`. For lower cost, add `llm:` with `model:` `claude-haiku-4-5-20251001` under it in `config.local.yaml`.
- Web searches cost \$10 per 1,000; limit them with `llm.web_search_max_uses`, or turn them off with `llm.web_search: false`.
- `/usage` in the terminal chat shows tokens; the Claude Console shows what you've spent.
- Say "new conversation" when you change topic: smaller requests cost less.
- Prompt caching is on by default and makes repeated context much cheaper.

If something looks wrong

Symptom	First thing to try
No "Claude replied" line in the doctor	The doctor's message says why: key, credit or model.
The microphone gives pure silence	Allow Microphone for Terminal, then quit and reopen Terminal.
Hotkeys do nothing	Allow Accessibility for Terminal; turn off Terminal, Secure Keyboard Entry.
Tutor mode only sees the wallpaper	Allow Screen Recording, then quit and reopen Terminal.
"Couldn't load the macOS app"	Run <code>./setup.sh</code> again.

For anything else, see the Debugging guide, and send me the doctor output and the end of `data/logs/jarvis.log`.